



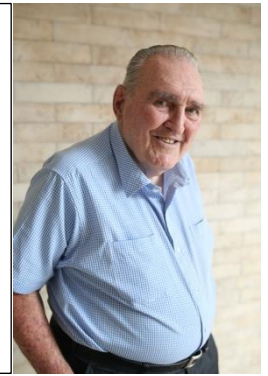
The Garamut **“The message sender”**

Ps Barry Reflections from ‘The WORD’!

**For PRAYER,
PROCLAMATION & PERSONAL
PROGRESS**

Bethel Global Missions

No. 33. 14th September 2026



OUR FOCUS: OPPORTUNITIES THAT SURROUND US EVERY DAY

GOD IS AT WORK ALL THE TIME

John 5:17 But Jesus answered them, My Father has worked [even] until now, [He has never ceased working; He is still working] and I, too, must be at [divine] work. AMP

John 5:17 Jesus said to them, “My Father is always at his work to this very day, and I, too, am working.” NIV.

THERE ARE **OPPORTUNITIES** ALL AROUND US, EVERY DAY **BUT WE MAY NOT SEE THEM.**

THE QUESTION IS:

ARE WE LOOKING FOR THEM?

ARE WE EARNESTLY ASKING GOD TO OPEN OUR EYES TO THE OPPORTUNITIES HIDDEN FROM OUR NATURAL SIGHT?

WHAT IS AN OPPORTUNITY?

AN OPPORTUNITY IS A FAVOURABLE SET OF CIRCUMSTANCES THAT MAKES IT POSSIBLE TO DO, ACHIEVE, OR EXPERIENCE SOMETHING DESIRED.

OPPORTUNITIES ARE A DOORWAY THAT OPENS THE POSSIBILITY FOR PROGRESS, WHICH REQUIRES RECOGNITION AND ACTION TO PRODUCE RESULTS.

OPPORTUNITIES ARE DIVINE INVITATIONS TO EXPRESS OUR FAITH, TRUST, AND RELIANCE ON GOD, STRETCHING OUR VISION AND EXPANDING OUR GODLY PURPOSE.

WE ARE ENCOURAGED TO TAKE HOLD OF / TO GRASP FIRMLY EVERY OPPORTUNITY THAT IS BEFORE US.

*Ephesians 5:15 - So be careful how you act; these are difficult days. Don't be fools; be wise: **make the most of EVERY OPPORTUNITY you have for doing good.** TLB*

EVERY DAY THERE ARE **OPPORTUNITIES ALL AROUND US** – AND JUST BECAUSE WE MAY NOT SEE THEM, IT DOES NOT MEAN THAT THEY DO NOT EXIST – **BECAUSE THEY DO EXIST.**

THE TRAGEDY OF MISSED OPPORTUNITIES.

THE BIBLE SUGGESTS THAT THIS STEMS FROM A LACK OF FAITH, OBEDIENCE, OR **DISCERNMENT.**

The different accounts in the Bible serve as cautionary stories, urging believers **to remain attentive to God's guidance and to seize the moments** that He provides for spiritual growth and service. Believers are to "make the most of every opportunity" (Ephesians 5:16) and to be wise stewards of the time and resources entrusted to them.

HAGAR THE SLAVE GIRL FAILED TO SEE – until God revealed it.

GOD HAD TO OPEN HER EYES TO THE WELL OF WATER FOR HAGAR TO SEE THE SOURCE OF LIFE THAT WOULD PRESERVE HER DYING SON.

THAT WELL HAD BEEN THERE ALL THE TIME – BUT SHE COULD NOT BENEFIT FROM IT – UNTIL SHE COULD SEE IT – GO TO IT AND DREW FROM IT.

Genesis 21:19 And God opened her eyes, and she saw a well of water; and she went, and filled the bottle with water, and gave the lad drink. KJV

JESUS' DISCIPLES FAILED TO SEE- until Jesus revealed it.

WHEN THE DISCIPLES FAILED TO CARE FOR OTHERS DAILY, THEY MISSED THEIR TRUE OPPORTUNITY TO SERVE JESUS. (Matthew 25:42-45).

Matthew 25:42-45 - 42 For I was hungry and you gave Me nothing to eat; I was thirsty and you gave Me nothing to drink; 43 I was a stranger and you didn't take Me in; I was naked and you didn't clothe Me, sick and in prison and you didn't take care of Me.' 44 "Then they too will answer, 'Lord, **WHEN DID WE SEE You hungry, or thirsty, or a stranger, or without clothes, or sick, or in prison, and not help You?**' 45 "Then He will answer them, 'I assure you: **Whatever you did not do for one of the least of these, you did not do for Me either.**' Holman

GOD'S IMPORTANT LESSON I NEEDED TO LEARN.

My personal testimony

I am reminded an instance where God taught me about seeing what HE HAD ALREADY PROVIDED for me through Christ Jesus.

This took place in Papua New Guinea at a time when I had set aside time for prayer and fasting and I chose an empty village style bamboo grass thatched roof, that belonged to the owner who was away on holidays.

It was cold, raining and the cold wind blew through the Bamboo walls and floor. Because my shoes were covered in mud, they had to be left outside the house, and my feet were desperately cold with no shoes. So, for two days as I marched around the room and I complained about my cold feet and of my failure to bring a second pair of shoes with me which was my normal habit.

For those two days and nights I suffered like this until the final day of departure, and for one more time I marched around the room and in the corner, I saw for the first time a pair of brown shoes that the owner of the house had left behind. Immediately the thought came to me "try them on", which I did, and they were my size perfectly and felt so comfortable and warm.

So, I suffered unnecessarily with cold feet for two days and could have had the comfort of those shoes that were there all the time - **but it did not happen because I had failed TO SEE them.**

GOD HAS NO OPPORTUNE TIME OR SPECIAL SEASON FOR HIM TO WORK AND DOES NOT HAVE TO WAIT FOR OUTWARD CONDITIONS TO IMPROVE.

GOD IS AT WORK IN WAR TIME OR IN PEACE, IN PANDEMIC OR PLEASURE, AND remember He who keeps Israel Shall neither slumber nor sleep. Psalms 121:4 NKJV

GOD IS PRESSING US TO UNDERSTAND AND BELIEVE THIS TRUTH THAT HE IS AT WORK ALL THE TIME THROUGHOUT THE WHOLE WORLD, INCLUDING; YOUR IMMEDIATE COMMUNITY, CITY, TOWN, REGION AND NATION.

THAT THIS IS ACTUALLY TAKING PLACE NOW – **even if you cannot see it yet.**

THE HOLY SPIRIT IS ALSO URGING US TO ASK OUR LORD TO OPEN OUR EYES SO THAT WE MIGHT SEE THE OPPORTUNITIES THAT ARE PRESENTLY ALL-AROUND US.

REGARDLESS OF OUR LOCATION OR WHAT OUR CIRCUMSTANCES MIGHT BE.

REGARDLESS OF OUR SIZE OR IMPORTANCE OF OUR CHURCH OR GROUP.

REGARDLESS OF WHAT WE MIGHT THINK OF OURSELVES, BEING ABLE, WORTHY OR NO **OPPORTUNITIES ARE HAPPENING AROUND US EVERY DAY.**

WE NEED TO BE A PEOPLE THAT ARE POSITIVE IN **BELIEVING THAT GOD IS AT WORK ALL THE TIME IN EVERY PLACE.**

ARE WE A PEOPLE WHO ARE **LOOKING, STRAINING (ON TIP TOE) TO SEE WHAT GOD MIGHT BE DOING IN PEOPLE NEAR US?**

HAVE WE DEVELOPED A **HABIT WHERE WE ARE CONSTANTLY ON THE LOOK OUT FOR A CHANCE TO DO GOOD AND TO TELL THE GOOD NEWS TO SOMEONE?**

WE NEED TO BE OPTIMISTIC AND NOT LIKE THOSE WHO **HAVE A MISTY OPTIC** AND CAN ONLY SEE THE NEGATIVE SIDE OF THINGS.